

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will create a 3D computer animation, *not* to exceed two (2:00) minutes, based on the assigned topic. Any secondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

Your local community is planning to build a new non-profit animal shelter to better serve abandoned, injured, and homeless animals. The goal of this shelter is not only to provide housing and medical care but also to promote adoption, education, and community involvement. Your project must include storyboard, concept art/prototype.

Your team has been selected to design and animate a 2-minute 3D model of this new animal shelter to help city leaders and donors visualize the facility before construction begins. _

Your animation must include:

- Exterior view of the animal shelter building
- Interior spaces such as:
 - Animal housing areas (dogs, cats, or other animals)
 - Medical and examination rooms
 - Adoption and meet-and-greet spaces
 - Intake and care areas
- Outdoor spaces such as:
 - Exercise yards or play areas
 - Walking or training paths

In addition to showcasing the facility, the animation must demonstrate how the shelter serves animals and the community. Teams should show at least one aspect of the intake, care, adoption, education, or volunteer process through animated movement, character interaction, or visual storytelling. Camera movement and scene transitions should be used to communicate the shelter's functionality and overall mission.

Team Must Supply

- Optional - Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.
- Optional - Props

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, contestants may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- Only the team captain should complete the submission
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit the following in one combined PDF: 1. Clickable URL to 3D Animation 2. Storyboard 3. Concept Art/Prototype 4. Works Cited 5. BPA Release Form(s) 6. AI Usage and Documentation Form	3DCAT-TeamID.pdf	April 1, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Utilize industry-standard editing and 3-D animation software and develop animations through storyboarding and scripting tools to ensure clear narrative structure, timing, and alignment with project objectives
2. Apply color grading, realistic textures, and dynamic special effects using modern digital tools to enhance visual impact, depth, and storytelling in multimedia projects
3. Incorporate seamless transitions, audio editing, lighting effects, and strategic placement of titles and graphics to enhance narrative flow and branding in multimedia projects
4. Apply audience analysis and design principles & elements to develop multimedia content that is relevant and engaging for defined target groups across platforms

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The team must create a 3D animation utilizing audio, text, video, and graphics
- Teams will research the topic using available references, time era, and trends to develop a storyboard outlining the team's planned animation
- Use of transitions and continuity must exist in the animation

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit the URL to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2027.
- Upload completed projects to a video/file sharing link (Vimeo, YouTube, Dropbox, etc.). Projects must be viewable on Windows and Mac platforms. Set the access level of your project to one of BPA's recommended settings. See the Cloud Sharing Guidelines for additional information.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

440 Computer Animation Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted the correct information, in the correct format, as one (1) PDF file: 1. Clickable URL to 3D Animation 2. Storyboard 3. Concept Art/Prototype 4. Works Cited 5. BPA Release Form(s) 6. AI Usage and Documentation Form				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-20 points	Above Expectations 21-30 points	Points Awarded
Originality of Assets	Assets are mostly pre-made, with minimal original work or poor integration of elements.	A balanced combination of original and pre-made assets clearly supports the project.	Predominantly original assets, creatively designed and well-integrated into the project.	/30
Attention to Detail in Modeling	Modeling techniques lack precision or complexity. Objects appear rushed or overly simple.	Models demonstrate care in construction and appropriate detail for the project.	Models show exceptional craftsmanship, detail, and technical skill throughout.	/30
Camera & Transitions	Poor or inconsistent use of camera work, timing, and transitions. Movement feels awkward or disruptive.	Camera angles, timing, and transitions are mostly smooth and support project pacing.	Camera work, timing, and transitions are dynamic, and polished, and enhance storytelling and clarity.	/30
Animation & Movement	Little or no use of foundational animation principles. Movements feel stiff, abrupt, or unnatural. Missing animation principles such as: Squash & Stretch, Anticipation, Slow-In/Slow-Out, and Secondary Actions.	Key animation principles are applied in several areas, improving movement realism and clarity. Some animation principles such as: Squash & Stretch, Anticipation, Slow-In/Slow-Out, and Secondary Actions are evident.	Strong, consistent use of multiple animation principles, resulting in a fluid, lifelike, and engaging motion throughout. Animation principles such as: Squash & Stretch, Anticipation, Slow-In/Slow-Out, and Secondary Actions are evident.	/30

440 Computer Animation Team
Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Planning & Execution	Limited or unclear pre-production materials such as concept art. Objectives are not well communicated visually.	Concept art and storyboards adequately illustrate the project's objectives and key ideas.	Concept art and storyboards are detailed, and creative, and clearly guide the final animation's vision.	/30
Overall Impact	Animation lacks energy or cohesion. Story and visuals fail to engage the viewer.	Animation effectively conveys the theme and entertains, with memorable moments.	Animation is highly engaging, polished, and memorable. Stands out for creativity and execution.	/30
Lighting Quality	Lighting is flat, unrealistic, or inconsistent. Scenes lack depth or mood.	Lighting is appropriate and supports mood, depth, and scene clarity.	Lighting is dynamic and effectively enhances atmosphere, focus, and storytelling throughout.	/30
Audio Quality	Audio is unclear, poorly mixed, or poorly timed. Distracts from the animation.	The audio is clear, appropriate, and supports the animation's tone and timing.	Audio is exceptionally clear, and well-mixed, and enhances mood, storytelling, and transitions.	/30
Scene Transitions	Transitions are rough, abrupt, or jarring, disrupting pacing.	Most transitions are smooth and appropriate for the project's pacing.	All transitions are seamless, and polished, and support the project's narrative flow.	/30
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-8 points	Meets Expectations 9-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Writing Accuracy	Multiple typos, grammar, or punctuation errors detract from professionalism.	Minor errors are present but do not significantly impact professionalism.	The text is clean, polished, and free of grammar, spelling, and punctuation errors.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/300

440 Computer Animation Team

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, use minimal gestures and body language, or have significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, use limited gestures and body language, or have some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, use appropriate gestures and body language, and vary their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-15 points	Meets Expectations 16-30 points	Above Expectations 31-45 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information	/45
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES